

What This Means for Pricing + Packaging (Simple Rules)

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Topic: What cruise visitors in Ensenada expect to eat, how much they spend, and how to reduce food “distrust.”



Question We're Answering (Cruise Guests in Ensenada)

Question:

When cruise guests get off the ship in Ensenada and take a tour, **what food do they expect** (American food vs Baja tacos vs seafood/lobster)?

Do they feel **distrust** about food?

How much are they willing to spend?

Goal: Use data (not guessing) to design the best food offer for cruise visitors.

Who the Ensenada Cruise Visitor Is (Key Facts)

ensenada cruise visitors (2024 study):

- **73% disembark** in Ensenada
- Average time in destination: **~5 hours**
- **73% made purchases** in the destination
- **46% purchased excursions** at the destination
- **92% live in the United States**
- Average spend per passenger: **\$63.68**

Implication: Most guests are U.S. travelers with limited time; many will spend money, but Ensenada is a relatively budget-controlled port.

What They Expect to Eat (Evidence)



Strongest evidence points to “local Baja food”

- Royal Caribbean’s Ensenada guide explicitly recommends street tacos and “bold Baja flavor.”
- Ensenada is widely marketed as a seafood destination, especially Baja fish tacos.

Premium food proof

- Carnival sells a Puerto Nuevo lobster lunch excursion for \$103.99/adult (meal included).
Meaning: Many cruisers will pay for lobster when it’s packaged as a safe, organized experience.

Comfort-food reality

- Since most visitors are U.S.-based (92%), a segment will prefer safe/familiar options (picky eaters, families).
So you should include one comfort option, but lead with Baja.

Food Trust/Distrust (What We Know From Safety Guidance)

There is no public “Ensenada distrust %,” but travel-health guidance explains why some travelers are cautious:

- Travelers often avoid high-risk food/water situations; they prefer hot cooked food, clean prep, bottled water.
- Seafood/raw items can raise caution for some travelers.

Implication for Pai Pai:

You don't need to “talk about fear,” just show clean prep + clear ingredients + cooked options and make bottled water easy to access.

How Much Will They Spend? (Data Anchors)

Ensenada spend anchor

Average spend per passenger in Ensenada: **\$63.68** (overall, not just food)

Food spend benchmark (cruise-wide)

Among parties who buy restaurant/bar food, average spend $\approx$ **\$54.65 per party** (~\$25.78 per passenger for those who do it)
Not everyone buys food onshore; many eat on the ship.

Premium pricing still possible

Lobster lunch excursions priced around **\$100+** exist and sell when packaged.

Recommended Menu Strategy for Pai Pai (Low Risk, High Conversion)

Use a “3-lane” menu that fits cruise behavior:

1. **Default Baja (most expected):**
 - Fish tacos (preferably grilled option) + rice/beans + salsa
2. **Premium Baja upgrade:**
 - Lobster-style option (lobster taco/plate) or “Baja seafood combo”
 - This matches what cruisers already buy as a premium meal excursion
3. **Comfort fallback (for picky eaters):**
 - Chicken tacos/quesadilla OR simple burger option

Key: Lead with Baja; comfort option prevents lost sales from cautious/picky guests.

What This Means for Pricing + Packaging (Simple Rules)

If food is separate:

- Many guests will accept roughly **\$20–\$30 per person** for a convenient, safe meal (benchmark)
- Make it fast and clearly explained (time matters: 5 hours total)

If food is included in a package:

- Food can justify higher excursion pricing if framed as “organized + premium”
- Premium add-on (lobster) can be a higher-tier package option if desired

References (APA 7)

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